



Seeking its Way

by Brad Gill

for flute (Naomi Johnson), recorder (Kathryn Bennetts), horn (Michael Hugh Dixon),
trombone (Greg van der Struik), vibraphone (Brad Gill)

Seeking its Way was composed for Sydney MicroFest 2026. It was inspired by the poem 'Gazing at the Moon' by the twelfth century Japanese recluse monk and poet Saigyō. The vibraphone is like the water 'trickling' through the material of the other players, eventually 'smothering' them like the moss covering the rocks. The vibraphone material is based on a series of eleven interval twelve note chords; the other instrument's material is microtonal and based on the harmonic and sub-harmonic series in two transpositions.

Below is the poem that inspired the work, in English translation (by Meredith McKinney in 'Gazing at the Moon: Buddhist Poems of Solitude', Shambhala, 2021) and the original Japanese.

Ice that sealed the rock gaps
this morning starts to melt –
under the moss
water trickles
seeking its way

iwama tojishi
kori mo kesa
toke – some-
koke no shitamizu
michi motomu nari